FT FollowThrough

The Appliance Repair Playbook

What to say from the first call to the five-star review. Copy the lines, put them in your own words, and keep this on your phone.

1. The first call or message

Sound calm, understand the job, and book a next step. Ask:

- Which appliance, and what is it doing (or not doing)?
- Is it leaking, sparking or smelling of gas? If so, turn it off at the valve or breaker first.
- What's the brand and model? Can you text a photo of the label inside the door?
- Is it under a manufacturer warranty or a home warranty plan?

> "Thanks for calling [Business], this is [Name]. Tell me what the [appliance] is doing and I'll see how we can help."

> "My service call is [price], and it comes off the repair if you go ahead. I can be there today at 2 or tomorrow at 10. Which works better?"

2. Presenting the quote

- Show the test: the meter reading or the failed part.
- Give one flat price for the repair, parts and labor, with your warranty in writing.
- When the appliance is old, show the repair price next to the cost of a new one, and say which you'd pick.
- Get approval before you order parts, and a deposit for expensive ones.

> "Here's what failed, here's the part, and here's the price with a [length] warranty. I can have it fixed by [day]. Would you like me to order the part?"

3. The 7 objections appliance techs hear and what to say

Acknowledge it, ask a question, answer honestly, suggest a next step.

1. "The other company charges less for the service call."
"That's fair to check. Does their fee cover a full diagnosis, or just showing up? Ask what the repair itself would cost and what warranty comes with it. My service call fee comes off the repair if you go ahead, and I'll put that in writing."

2. "I need to check with my landlord."
"Of course. Who should I send the details to? I'll write a short summary with the problem, the part, the price and photos, so they can approve it by text today."

3. "Can you do it any cheaper?"
"Let's look. Is the appliance under a manufacturer warranty or a home warranty plan? If not, I can use a quality aftermarket part where it makes sense. I won't skip testing after the repair, because that's what keeps me from coming back."

4. "I'll just buy a new one."
"That may be the right call. How old is it? If it's near the end of its life, replacing it makes sense, and I'll say so. If it's fairly new and the repair is a fraction of the price, fixing it usually pays off. Here are both numbers so you can choose."

5. “I’ll wait and see if it fixes itself.”
“I understand. Is it leaking or tripping a breaker? A small leak can ruin a floor, and a fridge that’s barely cooling can spoil food. I’ll hold today’s quote for a week, so you can call when you’re ready.”

6. “How do I know you’re not just selling me parts?”
“Fair question. Would you like to see the test? I’ll show you the reading on the meter and the failed part, and you can keep the old one. My repairs come with a written parts and labor warranty.”

7. “Why do I have to pay just for you to look at it?”
“Fair question. Has a repair company charged you before without explaining? The fee covers the trip and the testing to find the real fault, which is most of the work. It comes off the repair if you go ahead, and you’ll know the price before I order anything.”

4. Follow up: day 1, day 5, day 12

Most quotes go quiet, not “no”. Keep each message short and useful.

> **Day 1:** “Hi [Name], it’s [Your name] from [Business]. Here’s the repair price again next to the cost of a new [appliance], and how long the repair should last. Happy to answer any questions.”

> **Day 5:** “Hi [Name], checking in on your [appliance]. The part is in stock today. Want me to order it and book you for [day]?”

> **Day 12:** “Hi [Name], I’ll close out your quote on Friday. If it acts up again in the meantime, call me and I’ll come out first.”

“Repair or replace” customers decide fast. Follow up the next day, while they’re still standing in front of the broken appliance.

5. Ask for the review and the referral

Ask once you’ve tested the repair in front of them, and text a direct link to your Google review page.

> “Thanks again, [Name]. If you’re happy with the repair, would you leave a quick Google review? I’ll text you the link. And if a friend’s washer or fridge acts up, I’d be glad to help.”

Put a sticker with your number on the appliance. Landlords and property managers send repeat work, so leave them a card too.

Three rules that keep you out of trouble

- Get EPA 608 certified before sealed-system work, and check your state’s rules before you connect gas lines.
- Carry liability cover for water damage. A supply line you touched that leaks under a floor can cost more than a year of repairs.
- Write the diagnosis, parts, price and warranty down, and get approval before you order parts.

General education, not legal, tax or insurance advice. Rules and prices vary by state, so check yours.
The full start-up guide for appliance techs: followthroughguides.com/appliance-repair · Questions: info@followthroughguides.com